**Ingredients**
Know what's inside.

# Ingredients – Step-by-step guide

Version 0.5.0 · October 2026 · for Android 7.0 and newer

Ingredients checks food for you: scan the barcode and the app tells you whether the product suits your profile (no pork or alcohol, vegetarian, vegan, allergies, health) – and **why**, with sources. Free, no ads, your data stays on your phone.

## Contents


1. Part A — Install the app

1. The home screen
2. Create the profiles (once)
3. What I avoid, allergies
4. My health and My rules
5. Scan a product
6. Read the result
7. Why? and alternatives
8. The highlighted ingredient list
9. Health
10. An ingredient's page
11. Compare two products
12. History and favourites
13. Shopping list
14. Photograph a label
15. Add a product to Open Food Facts
16. Report an error, updates, delete everything


## Part A — Install the app

**Which APK?** On the download page: **"Standard"** fits almost every phone since 2017. If the phone says "App not installed" or "not compatible", take **"Older phones (32-bit)"**. If unsure: **"Universal"** (bigger, works everywhere).

### Before you start

- Be on **Wi-Fi** (the file is about **57 MB**, "Universal" 121 MB).
- Have at least **500 MB** free: `Settings → Battery and device care → Storage`.
- The APK from the download page.

## Method 1 — Directly on the phone (10 minutes)

1. **Turn off Auto Blocker** (Samsung): **Settings → Security and privacy → Auto Blocker → Off** (confirm with your PIN).
2. **Turn off Android "Advanced Protection"**, if your phone has it: type *Advanced Protection* in the Settings search bar. If it is on, turn it off (it forbids any installation outside the Play Store). If the search finds nothing, go to the next step.
3. **Download the APK**: open the link in **Chrome**. If Chrome warns "this type of file can harm your device", tap **Download anyway**. Wait for the download to finish.
4. **Open the file from "My Files"** (not from the notification): **My Files → Downloads → the .apk file**.
5. **Allow this source**: the phone says "your phone is not allowed to install unknown apps from this source". Tap **Settings**, turn on **Allow from this source**, then go back.
   Manual path if needed: **Settings → Apps → ⋮ (top right) → Special access → Install unknown apps → My Files** (and also **Chrome**) → **Allowed**.
6. Tap **Install**.
7. **If Google Play Protect blocks it** ("App blocked to protect your device" or "Unsafe app blocked"): tap **More details** → **Install anyway**.
   If there is only **OK**: open **Play Store → your profile picture (top right) → Play Protect → ⚙ (gear)** and turn off **"Scan apps with Play Protect"**, then repeat from step 4.
8. Open **Ingredients**. Done.
9. **Turn the protections back on**: Auto Blocker **on**, Play Protect **on**, and remove the "Install unknown apps" permission from My Files and Chrome. The app stays installed and keeps receiving updates.

## It doesn't work? Find your message

| What you see | Cause | Solution |
|---|---|---|
| "Installation blocked" / "blocked by Auto Blocker" | Auto Blocker still on | Step 1. Check that it really is **Off**, then restart the phone. |
| "...not allowed to install unknown apps from this source" | The app opening the file lacks permission | Step 5, for **My Files** AND **Chrome** (and WhatsApp/Gmail if the file came from there). |
| "Blocked by Play Protect" / "Unsafe app blocked" | Google doesn't know the app | Step 7 ("Install anyway", or turn off the Play Protect scan during the installation). |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| “App not installed” / “… package conflicts with an existing package” | An old Ingredients version from another source is installed | Uninstall the old Ingredients (long press on the icon → Uninstall), then install again. Settings must be set again. |
| “App not installed” / “not compatible” with no other detail | Wrong processor type, incomplete file or not enough space | Take **“Older phones (32-bit)”** or **“Universal”** on the download page. Check that the file is complete (57, 48 or 121 MB) in My Files; otherwise delete it and download again on Wi-Fi. Free some space. |
| “Parse error” / “There was a problem parsing the package” | File damaged during the download | Delete it and download again (method 1), or transfer it another way (method 2). |
| Nothing happens when tapping the file | Opened from the notification or a preview | Open it from **My Files** → **Downloads**. |
| “Blocked by your administrator” / work phone | Phone managed by a company (Knox, work profile) | Cannot be bypassed: use a personal phone. |
| Everything done and it still refuses | Unidentified Samsung/Google block | **Method 3** (USB cable + computer): it bypasses the phone’s installer. |

## Method 2 — Get the file another way

Useful if the download fails or the file is damaged. The .apk file can be sent:

- by **Quick Share** from another Samsung phone or a Windows PC (the file arrives in **My Files → Downloads**);
- by **USB cable** from a computer: connect the phone, choose **File transfer** in the USB notification, copy the file into the phone’s *Download* folder.

Then continue method 1 from **step 4**.

## Method 3 — USB cable + computer (always works)

This method worked when the direct installation was refused. You need a computer (Windows, Mac or Linux) and a USB-C cable that transfers data.

**On the phone:**

1. Turn on developer options: **Settings → About phone → Software information** → tap “Build number” **7 times** (enter your PIN). The message “Developer mode has been turned on” appears.

2. **Settings → Developer options** → turn on **USB debugging**.
3. Connect the phone to the computer, **unlock the screen**. At “Allow USB debugging?”, tick **Always allow from this computer** → **Allow**.

**On the computer:**

1. Download Google’s official “Android SDK Platform-Tools”: developer.android.com/tools/releases/platform-tools, and unzip the *platform-tools* folder (e.g. to *C:\platform-tools*).
2. Download the .apk file to the computer (e.g. into *Downloads*).
3. Open a terminal in the *platform-tools* folder (Windows: in Explorer, type `cmd` in the address bar and press Enter) and type:

```
adb devices
```

The phone must appear with the word `device`. If it says `unauthorized`, look at the phone and tap **Allow**. Then:

```
adb install -r "%USERPROFILE%\Downloads\ingredients.apk"
```

(replace with the real file name; on Mac/Linux: `./adb install -r ~/Downloads/ingredients.apk`). When `Success` appears, it is installed.

To finish: **Developer options → USB debugging** → **off**.

> **Safety:** only install APKs from a source you know (here: this page). Always turn Auto Blocker and Play Protect back on after the installation.

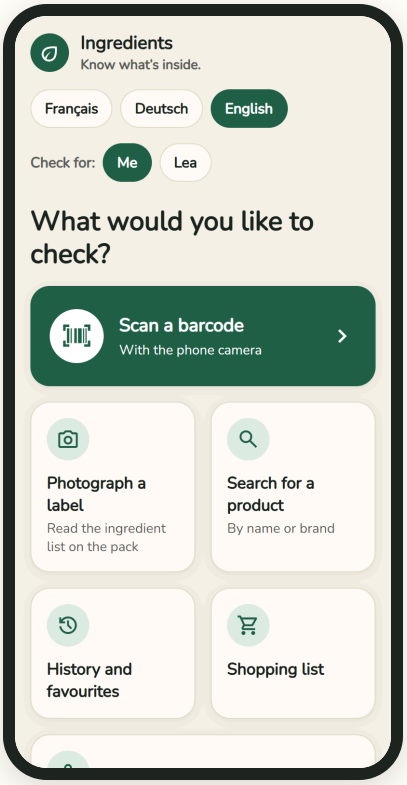
## After the installation: updates

- Each time it opens, the app downloads the new version in the background. A banner **“A new version of the app is ready”** offers **Restart to install it**.
- At the very bottom of the home screen, the **App version** block shows the version and a **Check for an update** button.
- No new APK needed, unless you are explicitly asked.

# Part B — Use the app

## 1 The home screen

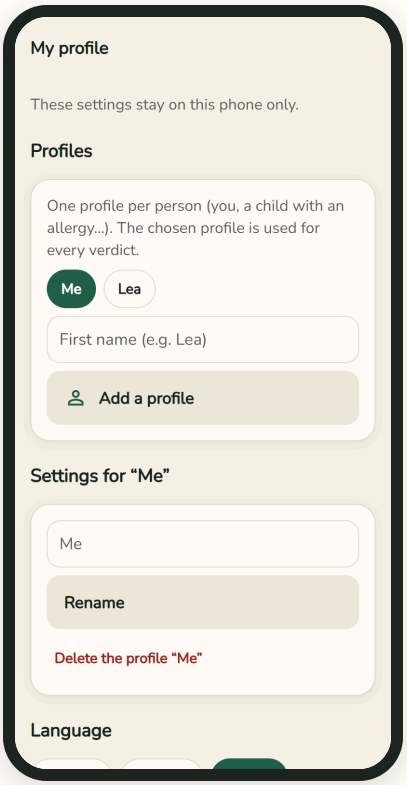
- At the top, the language: **Français**, **Deutsch** or **English**.
- **Check for:** shows whose profile is used (when there are several). Tap a name to switch.
- The big green **Scan a barcode** button is the quickest way.
- Below: **Photograph a label**, **Search for a product**, **History and favourites**, **Shopping list** and **My profile**.




## 2 Create the profiles (once)

Tap **My profile**. Everything stays **on your phone only**.

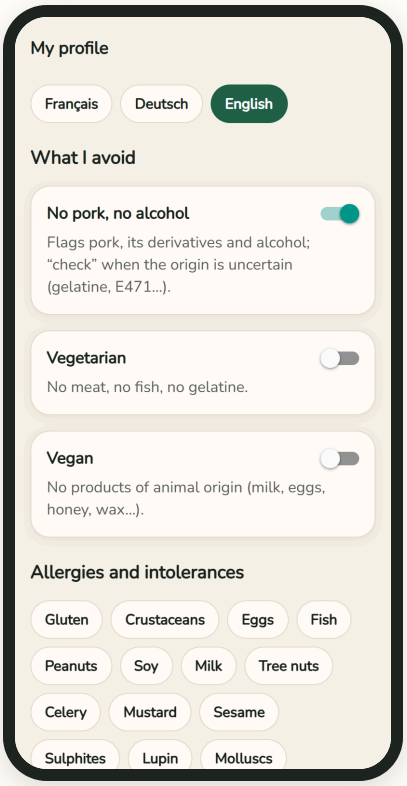
1. Under **Profiles**, "Me" already exists. For another person (e.g. a child with an allergy): type a first name → **Add a profile**.
2. The profile **in green** is the one you are setting up, and the one used for every verdict.
3. **Rename** changes the name; "Delete the profile …" removes it.



## 3 What I avoid, allergies

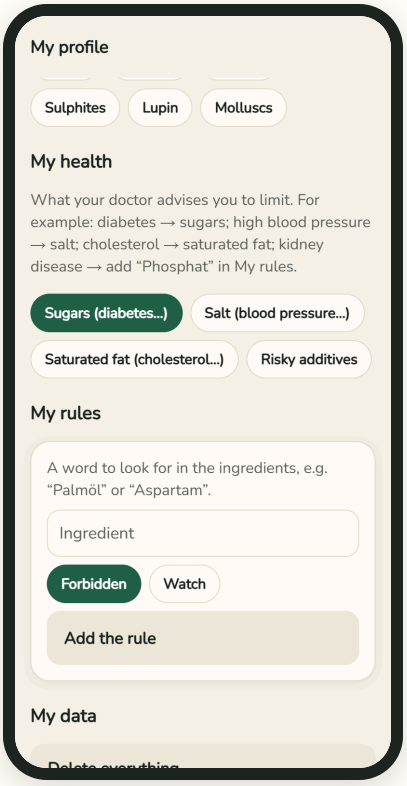
1. **What I avoid**: switches *No pork, no alcohol*, *Vegetarian*, *Vegan*. Under each one, exactly what is checked.
2. **Allergies and intolerances**: tap the 14 EU allergens that concern you (gluten, milk, peanuts, tree nuts…). Selected ones turn green.

Without a profile, the app explains the ingredients but gives no verdict.



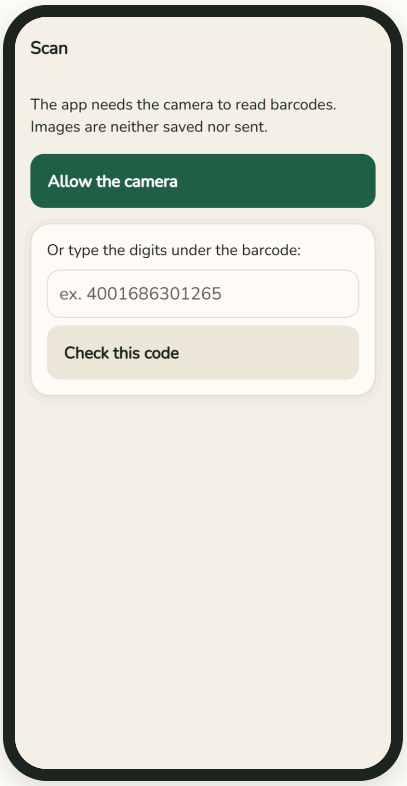

## 4 My health and My rules

1. **My health**: what your doctor advises you to limit – *Sugars (diabetes…)*, *Salt (blood pressure…)*, *Saturated fat (cholesterol…)*, *Risky additives*. A product high in it then becomes "Check".
2. **My rules**: your own word to look for, e.g. "Palmöl" (palm oil). Choose *Forbidden* or *Watch* → **Add the rule**.



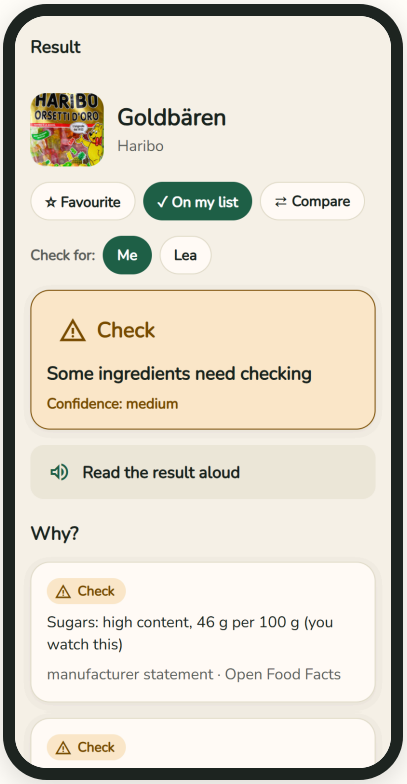
## 5 Scan a product

1. Home → **Scan a barcode**.
2. The first time: **Allow the camera**. Images are neither saved nor sent.
3. Hold the barcode inside the frame: the result opens by itself.
4. Not reading? Type the digits under the barcode → **Check this code**.



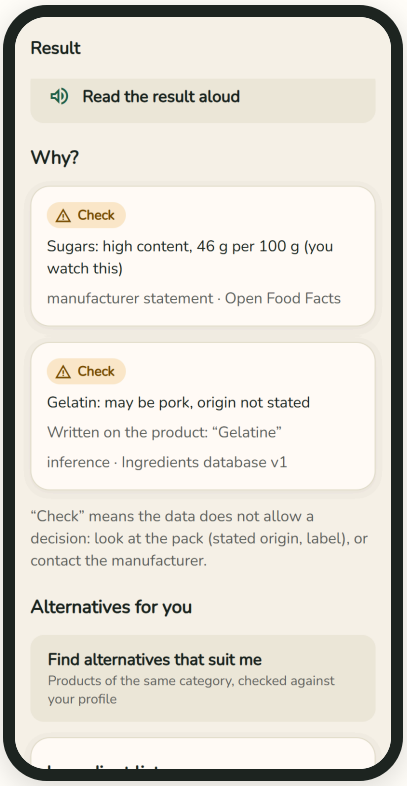

## 6 Read the result

1. At the top: photo, name and brand of the product.
2. Three buttons: **☆ Favourite**, **+ Shopping list**, **⇄ Compare**.
3. **The verdict** in a coloured card: **✓ Suitable**, **! Check**, **✕ Not suitable** or **? Unknown** (no ingredient list). Below it, the **confidence** (high, medium, low).
4. **Read the result aloud**: the phone reads the verdict out loud.



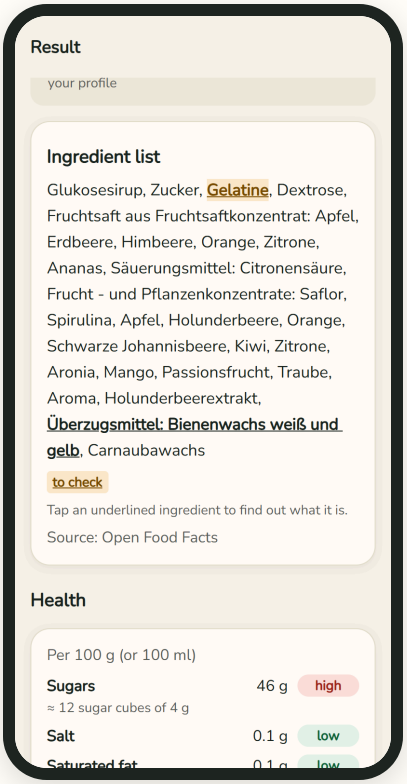
## 7 Why? and alternatives

1. **Why?** lists every reason for the verdict, with the word as written on the pack and its source.
2. “Check” means the data does not allow a sure answer (e.g. gelatine without the animal stated): look at the pack or ask the manufacturer.
3. **Alternatives for you**: **Find alternatives that suit me** shows products of the same category that suit you and are better on the problem point. **No advertising**: no brand pays.



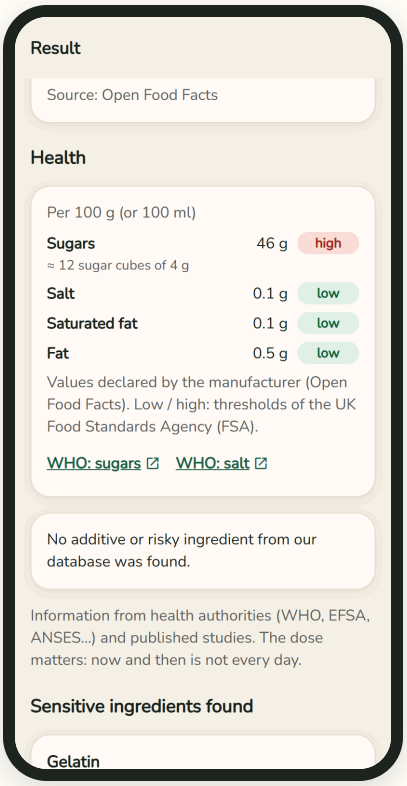

## 8 The highlighted ingredient list

- **red** = you avoid it · **orange** = to check · **purple** = health: watch.
- **Underlined** = explained ingredient: tap it to learn more.
- **Dotted** = ingredient the app does not know yet.



## 9 Health

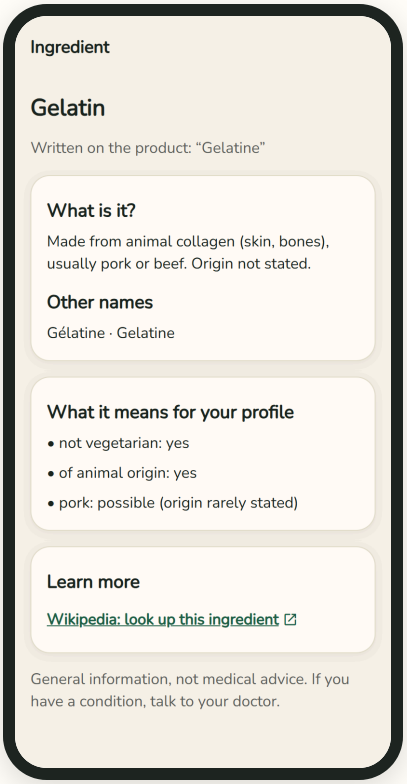
- Sugars, salt, saturated fat and fat **per 100 g**, with *low / moderate / high*.
- Sugars in sugar cubes, salt as a % of the WHO daily maximum.
- Then the risky ingredients with their level: *Recognised risk*, *To limit* or *Debated risk*, and their sources (WHO, EFSA…).
- A healthy product gets **Good choice!**




## 10 An ingredient's page

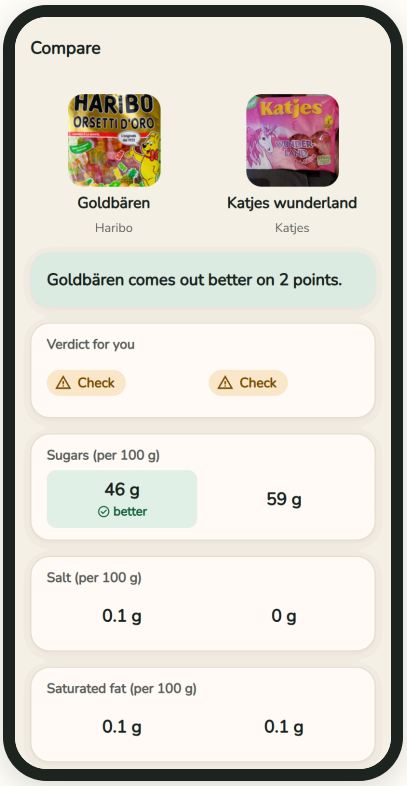
After tapping an underlined ingredient:

- **What is it?** – a simple explanation.
- **Other names** – how it appears on other labels (E numbers too).
- **What it means for your profile** and its effects on health.
- **Learn more** – links to Wikipedia and official sources.



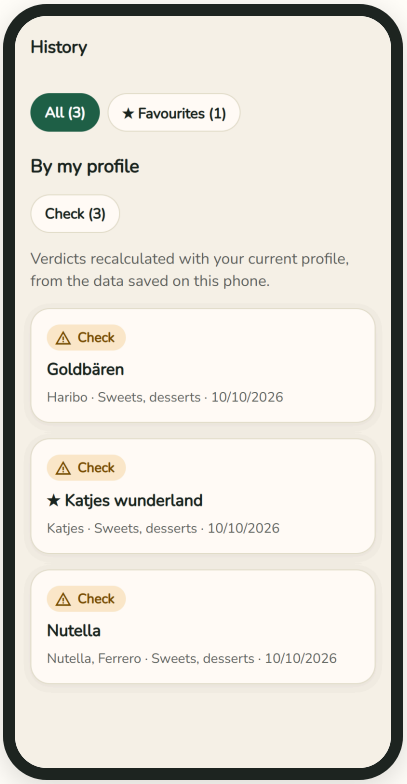
## 11 Compare two products

1. On a product: **⇄ Compare**.
2. Scan the 2nd product or pick it from your products.
3. Both side by side: verdict, sugars, salt, fat, risky additives, Nutri-Score. The better one is marked **better**. A difference under 10 % does not count.



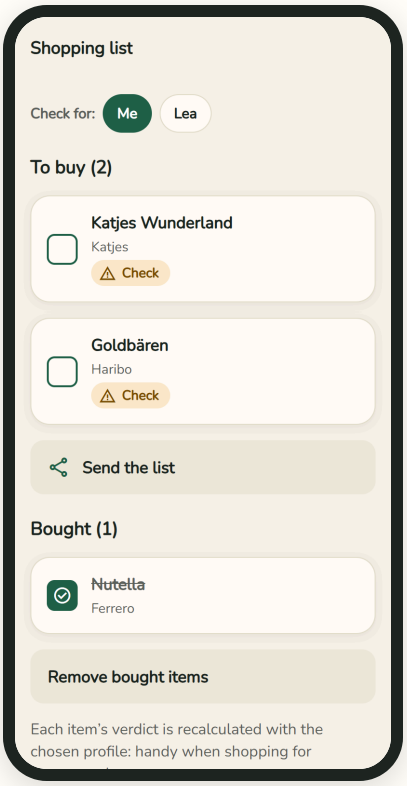

## 12 History and favourites

- Home → **History and favourites**: every product you opened, readable even offline.
- Filters: *All* / *★ Favourites*, by verdict (*Recommended, Check, Not recommended*) and by category (dairy, drinks, sweets…).
- Verdicts are recalculated with the chosen profile.



## 13 Shopping list

1. On a product: **+ Shopping list**.
2. Home → **Shopping list**: tick what you bought.
3. **Send the list**: by WhatsApp, SMS or e-mail.
4. Shopping for someone else? Choose their profile at the top: a red banner flags items that don't suit them.




## 14 Photograph a label

When a product is unknown or has no ingredient list:

1. **Photograph a label** (or, in the result, **Photograph the ingredient list**).
2. Photograph the "Zutaten" paragraph flat, sharp and well lit.
3. Check the text read and fix wrong letters → **Analyse** or **Use for this product** (kept for next time).

### 15 Add a product to Open Food Facts

Open Food Facts is the free database behind the app. A product you add will then be recognised **for everyone**.

1. Unknown product: **Add this product to Open Food Facts**. Product without a list: **Complete on Open Food Facts**.
2. Once: create a free account on openfoodfacts.org and enter your **user name** (not the e-mail) and password in the app. They stay encrypted on the phone.
3. Take the photos (front, ingredients, nutrition facts), check the text, accept the free licence → **Send to Open Food Facts**.

### 16 Report an error, updates, delete everything

- **Report an error** (at the bottom of every result): your mail app opens with a ready-made e-mail. Your profile is never sent.
- **Updates** arrive by themselves: when “A new version of the app is ready” appears, tap **Restart**.
- **My profile → My data → Delete everything**: profiles, history, favourites, shopping list and account are erased from the phone.

## Part C — Good to know

- The app **replaces neither the pack, nor your doctor, nor a religious authority**. It certifies nothing. With a severe allergy, always read the label.
- When it doesn’t know, it says so (“Unknown”, low confidence).
- No ads, no required account. Product data: Open Food Facts (ODbL licence). To read a photo, the image is sent to the OCR.space service; your profile, never.
- Questions or ideas? Write to draboibro@gmail.com.